

Context Clues and Multiple-Meaning Words

USA Grade 4 ELA
CCSS L.4.4.A

Name: _____

Date: _____

LEARNING TARGET

I can apply Grade 4 skills for word meaning and explain my thinking.

KEY STRATEGY + WORKED EXAMPLE

Test the possible meaning against grammar, nearby clues, and the meaning of the whole passage.

Read: The guide asked us to observe the seal from a distance. She sealed the sample jar so seawater would not leak. In this passage, seal is used with two meanings.

A. TRY TOGETHER - USE THE STRATEGY

1. Identify the worksheet focus: word meaning.
2. Underline the most important words in the model or source.
3. State one rule or reading strategy you will use.
4. Explain how you will check your answer.

B. CORE PRACTICE - SHOW YOUR WORK

5. Use the source text in the worked example.

6. Meaning of seal in sentence 1.

7. Meaning of sealed in sentence 2.

8. Which context words reveal meaning 1?

9. Which words reveal meaning 2?

10. Use bank in two different meanings.

11. Determine draft: A cold draft entered / I revised my first draft.

12. Explain how grammar helps with sealed.

C. INDEPENDENT FLUENCY - CALCULATE AND CHECK

13. Write a context sentence for spring meaning a season.

14. Write one accurate example of word meaning.

15. Write one non-example and explain why it fails.

16. Improve one earlier response with more precise vocabulary.

17. Underline the evidence or language feature in your improved response.

18. Write one question a careful reader or writer should ask.

19. Answer that question completely.

20. Check one response for conventions and correct it.

Name: _____

Date: _____

D. APPLY THE SKILL

21. Why can the same spelling have unrelated meanings?

22. Use context to distinguish bat the animal from bat used in baseball.

23. Write two linked sentences using one multiple-meaning word differently.

E. REASON, CHECK AND CORRECT

24. Explain why the word meaning strategy works.

25. Describe one likely mistake and show how to correct it.

EXIT TICKET + CHALLENGE

26. Apply the word meaning skill to one new example and explain your evidence or check.

Challenge: Create a rigorous new example of word meaning, solve or analyze it, and justify every decision.

F. STUDENT REVIEW - SHOW WHAT YOU UNDERSTAND

Use your own words so your teacher can see what you understand and what to practise next.

27. Explain one strategy you used today.

28. Check one answer in a different way.

29. Circle one: I understand it | I need more practice | I need help

30. The easiest part was: _____

31. The most difficult part was: _____

Why was it difficult? _____

32. My next practice step is: _____

TEACHER COPY - ANSWERS AND SUPPORT

ANSWER KEY

- A. 1) Focus named correctly. 2-4) Answers vary; strategy must be relevant.
- B. 5) source text. 6) marine animal. 7) closed tightly. 8) guide/observe/from distance. 9) jar/not leak. 10) Answers vary: river bank / financial bank. 11) moving air / early version. 12) -ed signals an action verb.
- C. 13-20) Answers vary; require accuracy, clear explanation, supporting evidence, and correct conventions.
- D. 21-23) Answers vary; use the requested structure and evidence.
- E. 24) Answers vary; explain the strategy, not just the answer. 25) Answers vary; include a corrected example.
- EXIT. 26) Teacher checks accurate application and explanation.
- Challenge: Answers vary. Check that the student's example follows every condition and that the reasoning is mathematically correct.
- F. 27-28) Answers vary. Look for a clear strategy and a valid second check. 29-32) Use the reflection to identify confidence, difficulty and the next teaching step.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

Watch for answers that name word meaning without evidence or explanation. Ask the student to point to the exact clue, rule, or text detail.

TEACHER CHECK

- ☐ Uses an appropriate Grade 4 ELA strategy.
- ☐ Shows or explains thinking clearly.
- ☐ Checks a response using evidence, a rule, or a second method.
- ☐ Identifies a specific difficulty and useful next practice step.

PARENT / TEACHER TIP

Ask the child to explain how they know, not only state an answer. Have them point to the text evidence or language rule, then revise one response aloud.

NEXT STEP

Revisit the item the child marked difficult. Model one example, solve one together, then ask the child to complete one independently and explain the strategy.